All in all, the pandemic has taught India several lessons from which we have emerged and grown. It may be premature to assume that more waves of the mutating virus will not hit us. However, we are far better prepared to deal with them. Combined with wide vaccine coverage and high immunity as revealed by sero-surveys, India believes that we may be able to face any upcoming waves of the virus, with much lower devastation. In a way, we have come to realize how protectionist and one-sided the world has come to be. Such a situation, compounded with the challenges during the pandemic years domestically, have compelled us to place much more emphasis on self-reliance by ushering in policies which are self-generating and self-sustaining.

Atmanirbharta by its very performance brings in greater innovation and creativity, while remaining an integral part of global networks. Atmanirbharta makes it clear that only when India's own production flourishes can it make an economic difference abroad. As the world revisits its supply chains, it is likely to see a greater deficit in the availability of global goods. Several countries are likely to reconsider rebuilding their supply chains and depending much lesser on countries which have maintained an opaque and territorial approach during the pandemic years. India, in such a situation, can be poised to take the place of a trustworthy ally, by vividly expressing its beliefs and traditions which speak volumes of our non-extremist attitude. Several countries, including major power nations, have come to realize that trade engagements based on economic outcomes are not sustainable, especially at the cost of running a risk of erosion of the social fabric. Due to this, moving forward, nations will also look to build stronger relations with countries who come from similar belief systems. India, over the past few years, has been forthcoming in asserting its role and thought processes in several global forums, giving the world an opportunity to get to know us better. We have demonstrated over and over that we aren't an expansionist regime. Instead, we call our motherland Bharat mata (mother), signifying our nurturing approach to multilateral and bilateral relations, a deeply maternal behaviour. In times of crisis, just like a mother would, we are fully capable of synchronizing our energies and displaying unimaginable strength to protect not just our own but all of humanity. For instance, during the pandemic, India stood firmly with